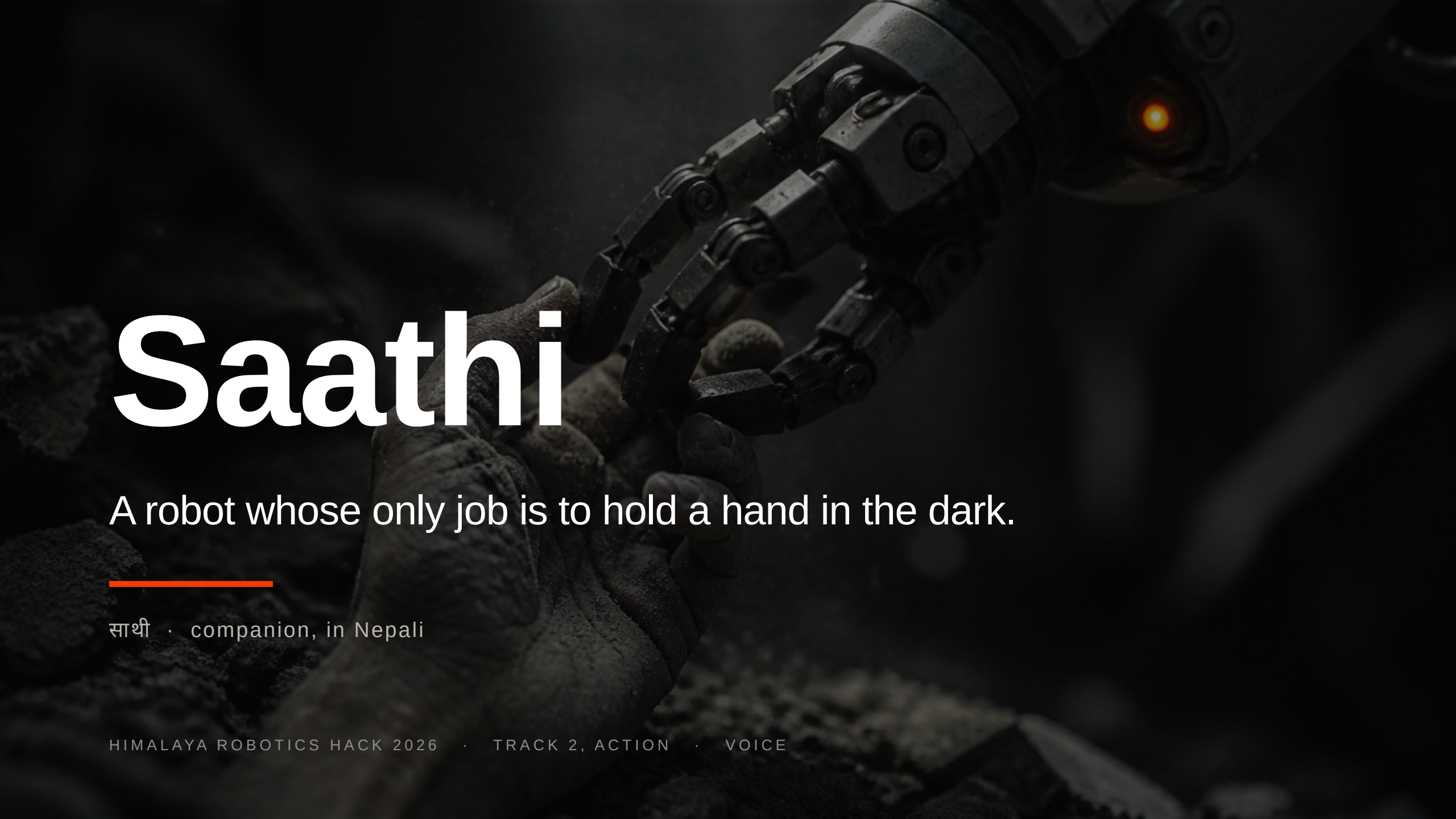


A close-up, dark, and moody photograph of a robotic hand holding a human hand. The robotic hand is metallic and complex, with a glowing orange light in its upper section. The human hand is weathered and appears to be holding the robot's hand. The background is dark and textured, possibly a rocky surface.

Saathi

A robot whose only job is to hold a hand in the dark.

साथी · companion, in Nepali

HIMALAYA ROBOTICS HACK 2026 · TRACK 2, ACTION · VOICE

WHY THIS ONE

Part of my family is from these mountains.

I have ridden these roads. When the Bhote Koshi came down it went through places I know.

**This is not a case study
I picked.**





RASUWA, NEPAL · 26 AUGUST 2026

A glacier fell 1,200 metres.

It dammed a river. The dam burst.



FOUR DAYS LATER

669

CONFIRMED DEAD

2,900

STILL MISSING

93,000

AFFECTED

42 km

OF ROAD, EVERY BRIDGE

**Nepal asked for help
with two things.**

Tunnel rescue. Identifying the dead.



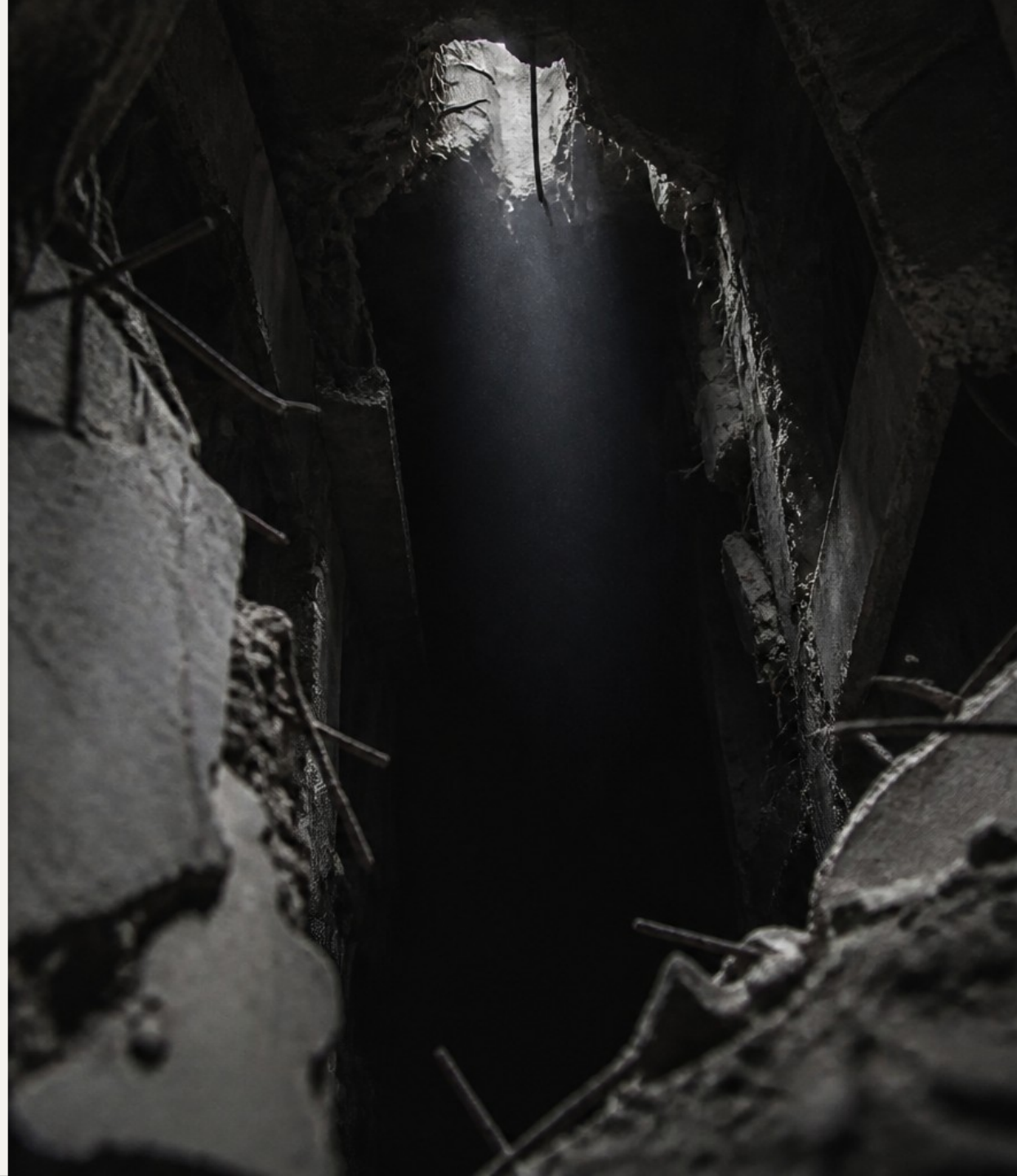
THE GAP NOTHING OCCUPIES

The warning is minutes.
The rescue is hours.

WHAT ACTUALLY KILLS THEM

They do not die of injury. **They die alone.**

So doctrine is to get a voice to the person and hold it there for the whole dig. Today that means a human face down in silt, one arm through a gap, six hours.

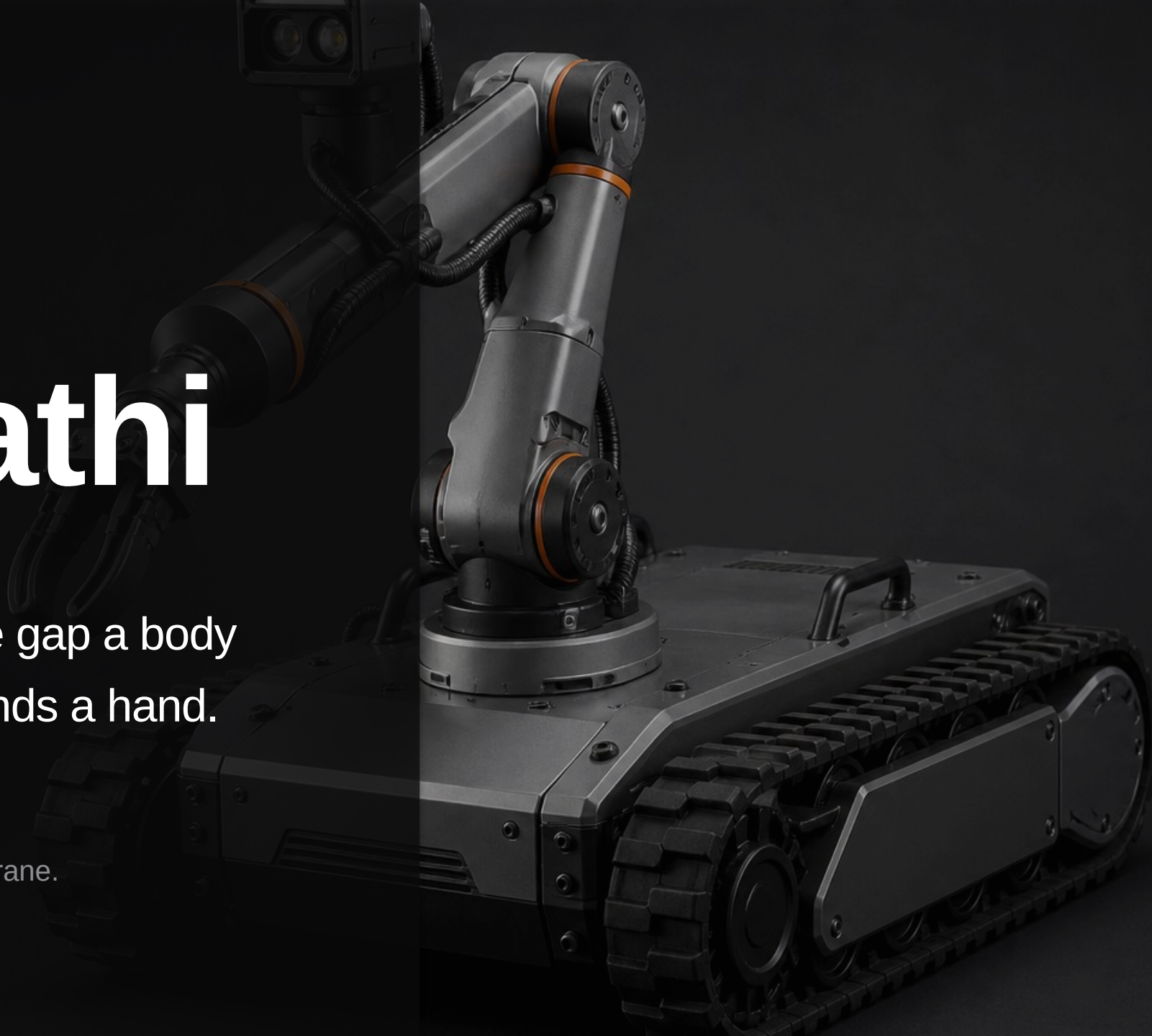


INTRODUCING

Saathi

It enters the gap a body
cannot. It finds a hand.
It holds on.

Company, not a crane.



WHAT THE HAND IS FOR



HOLD

Closes on force,
not on position.



SUSTAIN

Water, light, air
down the same tether.



SPEAK

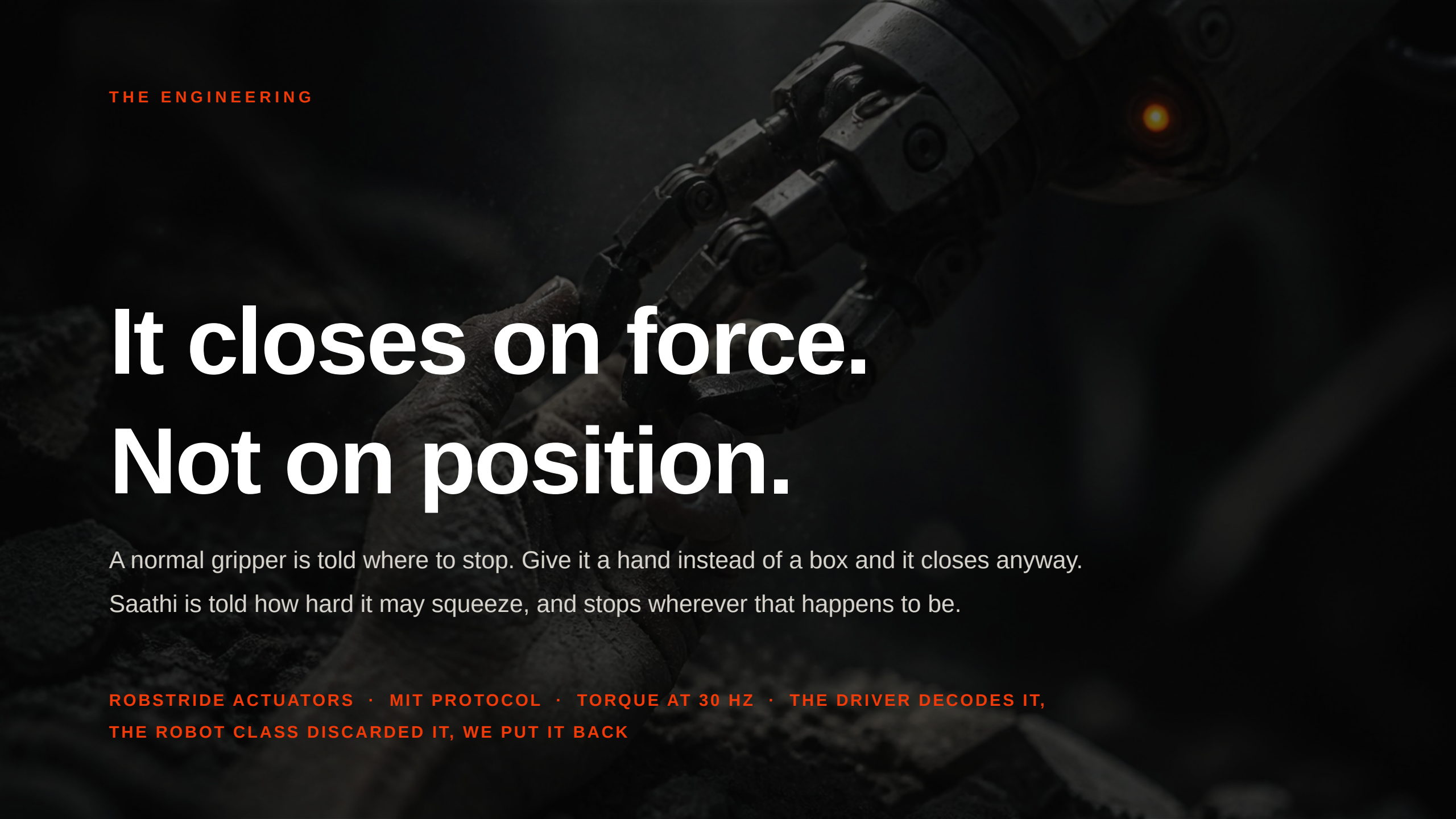
Nepali, generated
on the device.



MARK

Records the place.
Moves nothing.

One hand. Four jobs. All of them contact.

A close-up, dark-toned image of a robotic gripper holding a human hand. The gripper is metallic and complex, with a small orange light visible on its upper arm. The human hand is positioned palm-up, and the gripper's fingers are wrapped around it. The background is dark and textured, resembling rocks or a cave.

THE ENGINEERING

It closes on force. Not on position.

A normal gripper is told where to stop. Give it a hand instead of a box and it closes anyway. Saathi is told how hard it may squeeze, and stops wherever that happens to be.

ROBSTRIDE ACTUATORS · MIT PROTOCOL · TORQUE AT 30 HZ · THE DRIVER DECODES IT,
THE ROBOT CLASS DISCARDED IT, WE PUT IT BACK

IT HAS TO WORK WITH NOTHING

No internet in that valley.

Every cloud assistant on earth is inert down there. So the speech runs on the robot.

Kriti

Nepali ASR · rank 1 · MIT · built in Kathmandu

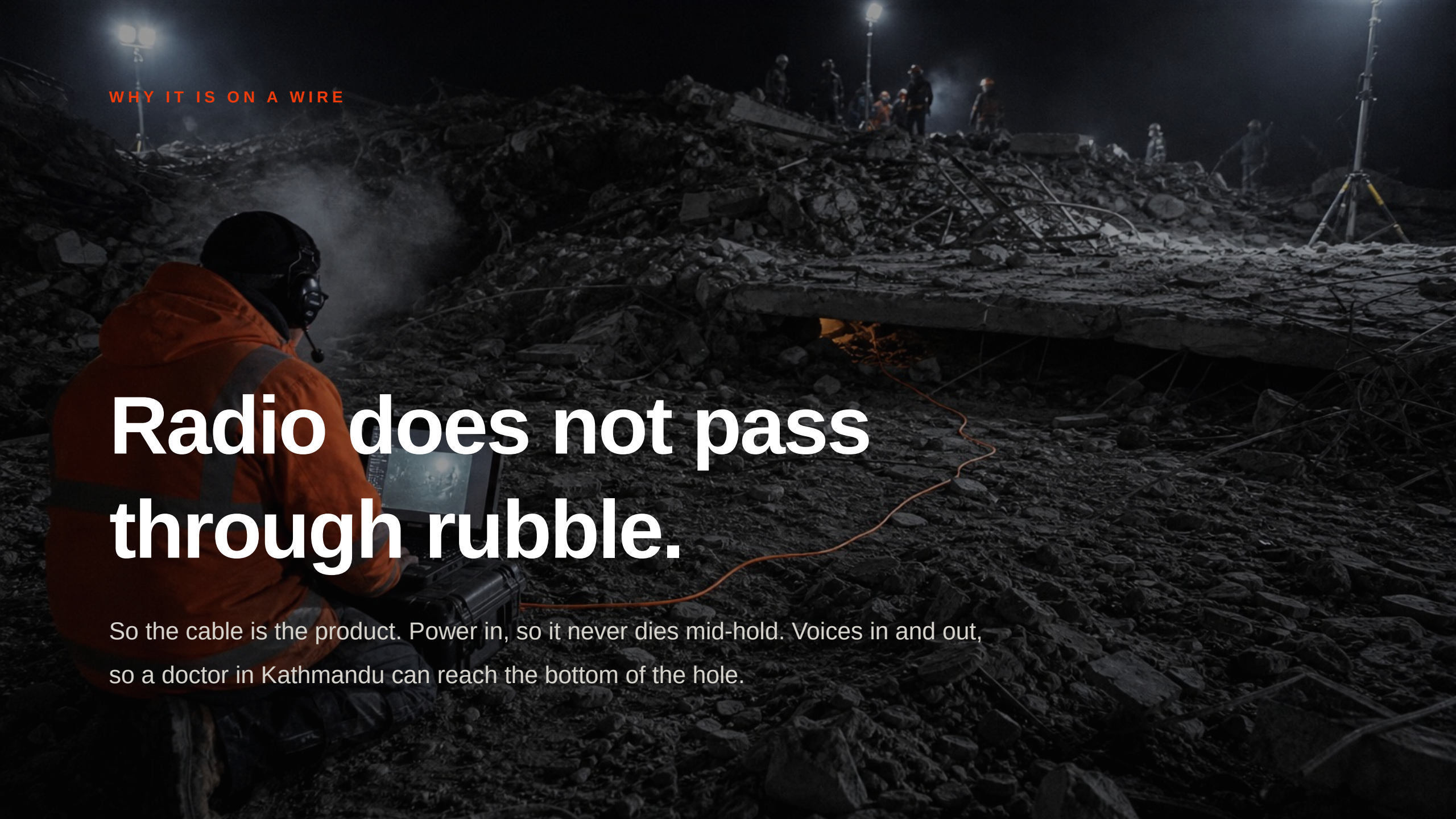
Kala

Nepali TTS · 60 MB ONNX · 50x real time on CPU

Voices v0

419 speakers · match a family member

About 2 GB. On battery. Underground.

A night-time photograph of a disaster site. In the foreground, a person wearing an orange jacket and a helmet with a microphone is kneeling, looking at a laptop. A red cable runs from the laptop across the dark, rocky ground towards the background. In the background, several other people are standing on a pile of rubble, illuminated by bright spotlights. The scene is dark and atmospheric, with smoke or dust in the air.

WHY IT IS ON A WIRE

Radio does not pass through rubble.

So the cable is the product. Power in, so it never dies mid-hold. Voices in and out, so a doctor in Kathmandu can reach the bottom of the hole.



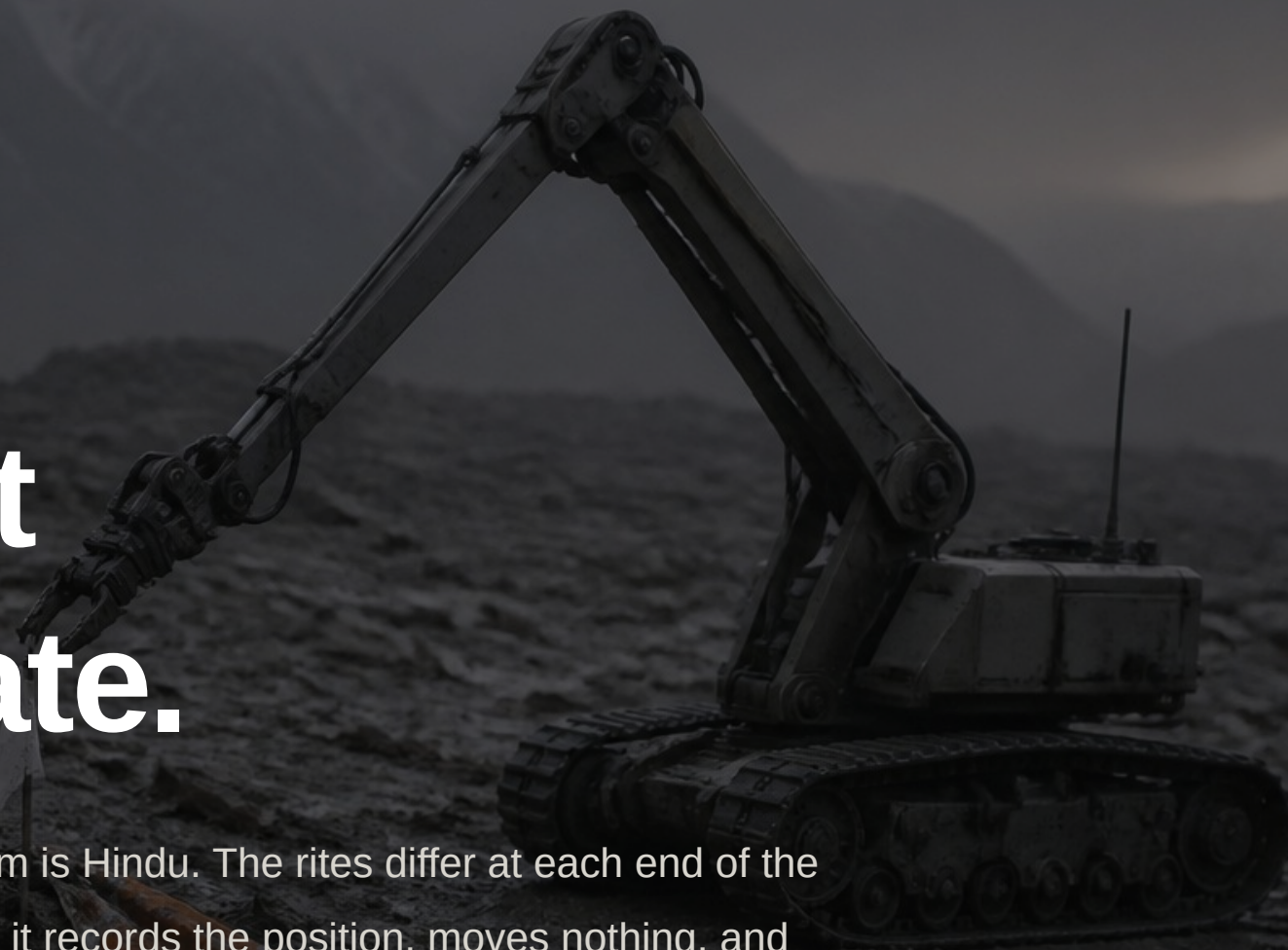
The hold is why
they keep answering.

The water is why they are still alive to answer.

Same gripper. Same tether. No second mechanism.

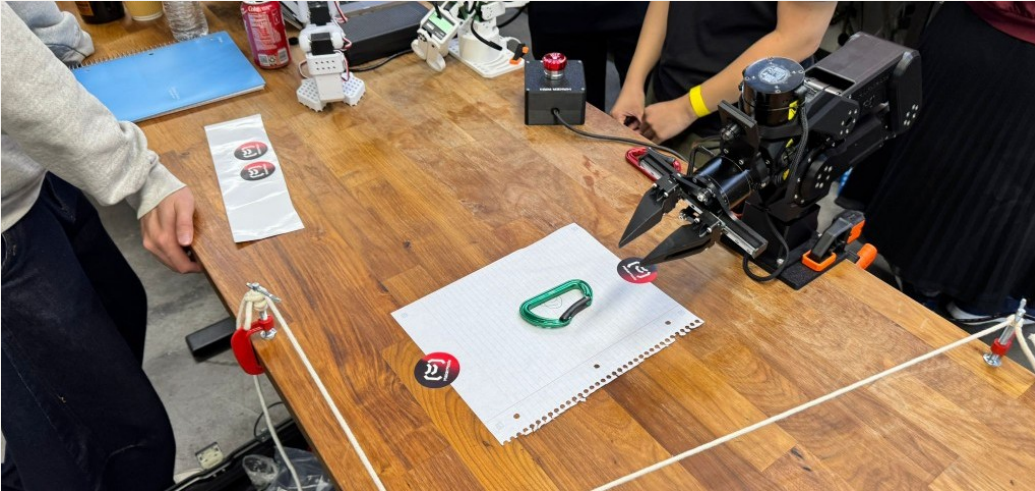
Sometimes it arrives too late.

Rasuwa is Tamang and Buddhist. Downstream is Hindu. The rites differ at each end of the same river, and neither is ours to perform. So it records the position, moves nothing, and leaves a marker so the family and the right people can find the place.

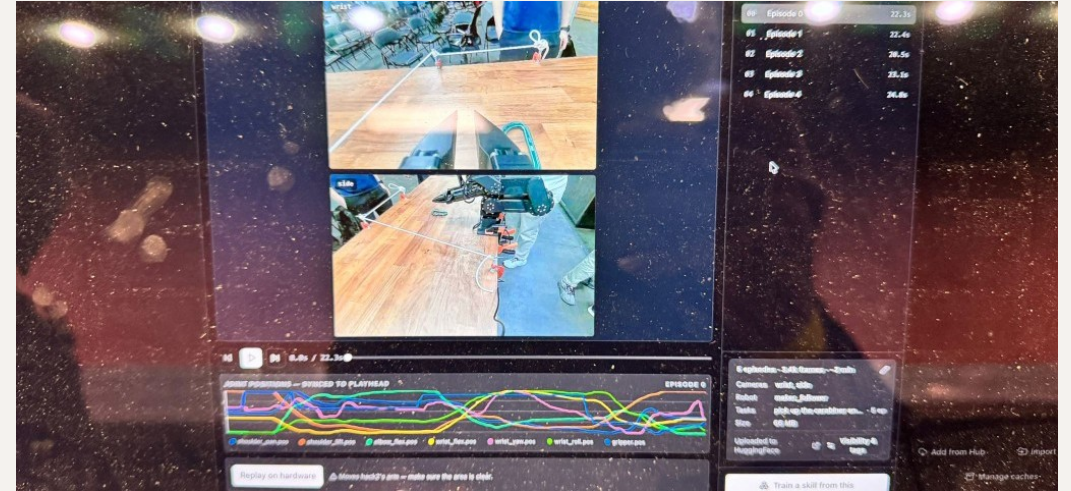


HONEST SCOPE · SHOT AT THIS TABLE

Built this weekend.



THE ARM, THE ROPE RIG, THE E-STOP



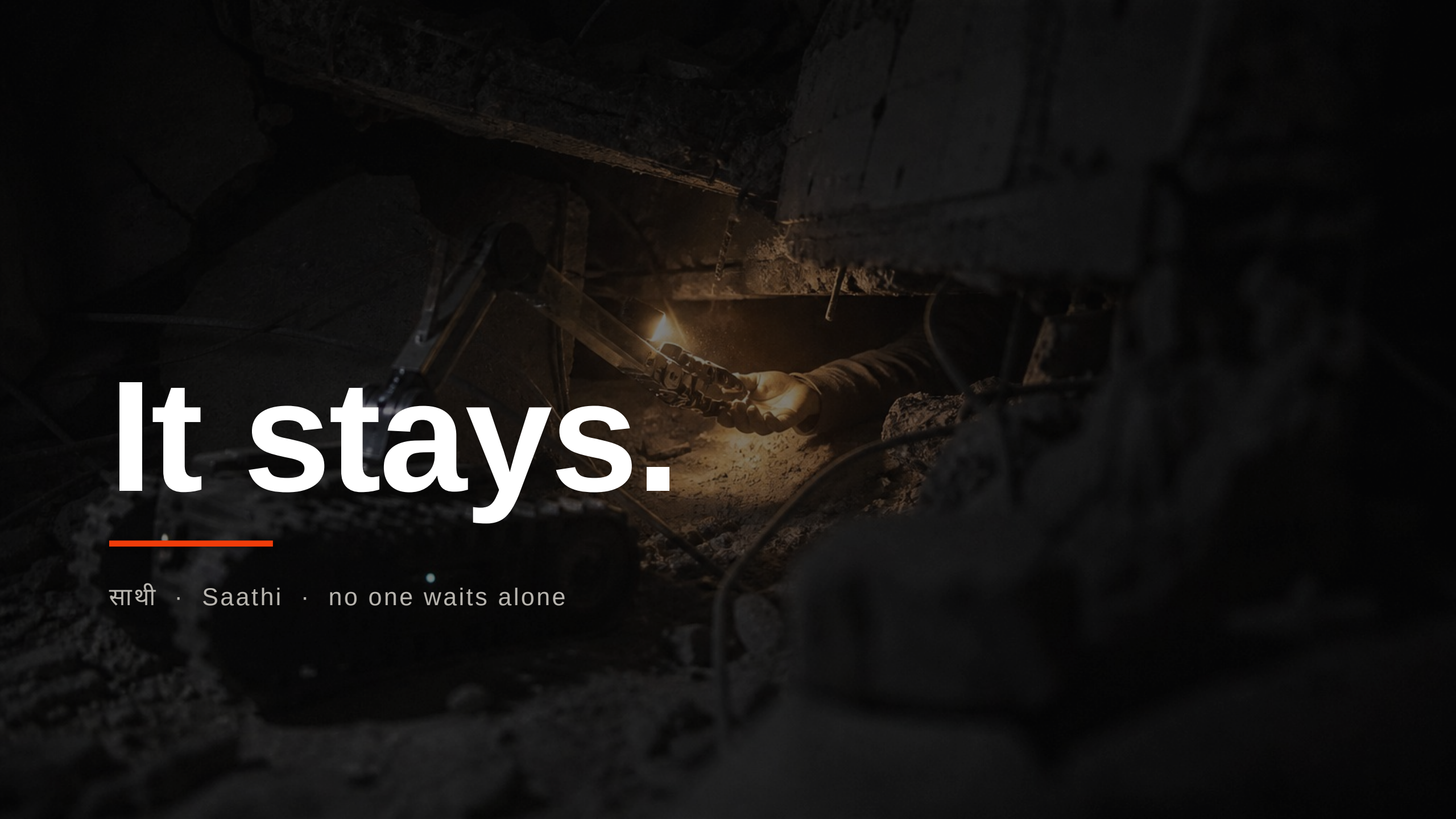
RECORDED EPISODES IN THE LEROBOT VIEWER

REAL 6-DOF RobStride arm live on LeRobot, MIT protocol over CAN.

REAL A force-limited close, replayed on a live human hand, Nepali speech on contact.

REAL Per-joint torque pulled out of a driver that was discarding it.

RENDER The tracked chassis. Everything above was shot on this table.

A dark, industrial background featuring a robotic arm holding a glowing, metallic object. The scene is dimly lit, with the primary light source being the glow from the object held by the arm. The background shows various mechanical parts and structures, creating a sense of a deep, underground or industrial environment.

It stays.

साथी · Saathi · no one waits alone